TRAVEL GUIDE

Sample Itineraries

Seven ready-to-adapt day-by-day itineraries covering classic beach breaks, family vacations, adventure trips and off-the-beaten-path routes.

Prepared for NotebookLM practice exercise - Unicorn University AI Software Development Course

Concrete day-by-day itineraries for different vacation styles and lengths. Use these as templates - they combine locations from the regions guide, the activities menu, and realistic driving times.

Itinerary 1 - Classic 7-day beach vacation (Punta Cana focus)

For: first-timers, families, honeymooners who want low-effort relaxation with a couple of highlights.

Base: All-inclusive resort in Bavaro or Cap Cana.

Day	Plan
1 (Sat)	Arrive at PUJ. Transfer to resort (30 min). Beach + welcome drinks. Book excursions and specialty-restaurant slots at the concierge.
2 (Sun)	Full resort day. Beach in the morning, pool in the afternoon. Try a resort excursion catalog. Buffet dinner + evening show.
3 (Mon)	Saona Island full-day catamaran excursion. Early pick-up (7:30), back by 17:00. Restaurant reservation and cocktails.
4 (Tue)	Resort day: spa morning + snorkeling gear from the beach hut + water aerobics.
5 (Wed)	Hoyo Azul + Scape Park half day (zip lines, cenote). Afternoon beach + sunset.
6 (Thu)	Resort day. Try the specialty a la carte you didn't book. Optional: sunset horseback ride on the beach (US$50-80).
7 (Fri)	Slow morning. Playa Macao trip (public beach with fresh lobster, 30 min from resort). Afternoon at resort. Farewell dinner.
8 (Sat)	Late checkout or airport transfer. Return home.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$3,000-5,500 excluding flights.

Itinerary 2 - 10-day mixed vacation (Punta Cana + Samana)

For: couples or families who want beach relaxation **and** nature/culture. Adds two locations without feeling rushed.

Base: 4 nights Punta Cana + 3 nights Las Terrenas + 2 nights Santo Domingo.

Day	Plan
1	Arrive PUJ. Punta Cana resort. Beach + pool.
2	Saona Island excursion.
3	Resort day / snorkeling / spa.
4	Bavaro Runners buggy tour or Scape Park. Afternoon beach.
5	Check out early. Drive to Las Terrenas (~4 hours) or fly PUJ->AZS. Boutique-hotel check-in. Sunset dinner at La Terrasse.
6	El Limon Waterfall morning excursion. Afternoon at Playa Coson.
7	Los Haitises National Park boat tour. Evening bachata lesson at a Las Terrenas bar.
8	Drive to Santo Domingo (~3 hours). Check into a Zona Colonial boutique. Evening walk on Calle Las Damas.
9	Full day in Zona Colonial: Alcazar de Colon, Cathedral, Fortaleza Ozama. Los Tres Ojos afternoon. Dinner at Meson D'Bari or Adrian Tropical.
10	Kah Kow chocolate factory morning. Airport transfer to SDQ, fly home.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$4,000-7,500 excluding flights.

Itinerary 3 - 14-day "see the whole country" adventure

For: confident travelers renting a car who want a genuine cross-section of the Dominican Republic. Not for those seeking pure relaxation.

Base: Rotates through 5 regions.

Day	Plan
1	Arrive Santo Domingo (SDQ). Check into Zona Colonial hotel. Evening dinner + walk.
2	Santo Domingo culture day: Cathedral, Alcazar, Museo del Ambar. Faro a Colon.
3	Pick up rental car. Drive to Bayahibe (2 h). Check into boutique or resort. Sunset on Playa Dominicus.
4	Catalina Island dive/snorkel trip. Afternoon: relax. Evening dinner at Mare Nuestro.
5	Drive to Punta Cana (~1.5 h). Resort or boutique check-in. Beach afternoon.
6	Saona Island excursion.
7	Drive to Samana (~4 h). Check into Las Terrenas boutique. Sunset.
8	Whale-watching (January-March) or Cayo Levantado boat trip.
9	El Limon Waterfall + Playa Rincon.
10	Drive to Cabarete (~4 h). Check in. Sunset kite lesson.
11	Cabarete water sports morning. Afternoon: 27 Charcos de Damajagua.
12	Playa Grande or Rio San Juan day. Evening in Cabarete.
13	Drive to Jarabacoa (~2 h). Salto de Jimenoa hike. Overnight in a mountain lodge.
14	Whitewater rafting or coffee-farm tour. Drive to STI or SDQ airport (2-3 h). Fly home.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$5,500-10,000 excluding flights.

Itinerary 4 - 7-day off-the-beaten-path (nature and culture, no resort)

For: independent travelers who dislike all-inclusives and want a country-first, tourist-second trip.

Base: 2 nights Santo Domingo + 3 nights Las Terrenas + 2 nights Jarabacoa.

Day	Plan
1	Arrive SDQ. Zona Colonial boutique. Sunset drinks in Plaza de Espana.
2	Deep-dive Zona Colonial: Museo Casas Reales, Ozama Fort, Kah Kow tour.
3	Fly SDQ -> AZS or drive to Las Terrenas. Sunset at Playa Bonita.
4	Los Haitises National Park boat tour (early). Evening seafood at La Terrasse.
5	Boat trip to Playa Fronton + Playa Madama (from Las Galeras).
6	Drive south to Jarabacoa (5 h - a long day). Check into mountain lodge.
7	Salto de Jimenoa + Baiguate half-day. Coffee farm afternoon. Return to SDQ or STI for flight.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$2,800-5,000 excluding flights.

Itinerary 5 - 10-day family vacation with kids

For: families with kids aged 5-14. Balance of pool time, adventures, and cultural exposure.

Base: 7 nights Bavaro family resort + 2 nights Bayahibe boutique.

Dominican Republic - Sample Itineraries

Day	Plan
1	Arrive PUJ. Family resort check-in. Pool + kids' club orientation.
2	Beach day. Sign kids up for the resort activity program.
3	Dolphin Discovery / Marinarium half day.
4	Resort day. Parents do the spa; kids do the water park.
5	Scape Park - Hoyo Azul, zip lines (age-appropriate for 6+).
6	Saona Island family excursion.
7	Resort day. Evening baseball (if in season).
8	Drive to Bayahibe boutique (1.5 h). Playa Dominicus.
9	Snorkel trip to Catalina Island - kid-friendly reef.
10	Airport transfer to PUJ. Fly home.

Approx. budget for family of four, all-in: US$5,500-9,500 excluding flights.

Itinerary 6 - 7-day active / adventure

For: kitesurfers, divers, hikers, and adrenaline seekers.

Base: 7 nights Cabarete + optional Jarabacoa extension.

Day	Plan
1	Arrive POP. Transfer to Cabarete (30 min). Check in. Sunset kite lesson intro.
2	Full-day kite course (part 1) at Kite Beach.
3	Full-day kite course (part 2). Evening dinner on the beach.
4	27 Charcos de Damajagua. Afternoon: rest.
5	Independent kite / surf. Try Playa Encuentro for surf.
6	Whitewater rafting Rio Yaque del Norte (long day trip from Cabarete).
7	Beach morning. Fly out from POP or add optional 2-night Jarabacoa extension for canyoning and Pico Duarte prep.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$2,500-5,000 excluding flights.

Itinerary 7 - 5-day short break

For: European or US East Coast travelers on a long weekend.

Base: Punta Cana all-inclusive.

Day	Plan
1	Arrive PUJ. Beach afternoon. Resort evening.
2	Saona Island excursion.
3	Resort day. Spa + specialty restaurant.
4	Scape Park or Playa Macao half day. Beach afternoon.
5	Slow morning. Airport transfer.

Approx. budget for two, all-in: US$1,800-3,500 excluding flights.

When to travel - seasonal itinerary picks

Dominican Republic - Sample Itineraries

Travel window	Best itinerary
December-March	1 (Punta Cana), 2 (Punta Cana + Samana for whales), 5 (family)
April-May	2 (mixed), 4 (off-the-beaten-path)
June-August	6 (kitesurfing)
September-October	Best deals; watch hurricane forecast; short trips (7)
November	Any - value season

Pacing tips

- **Never plan a full-day excursion on your arrival or departure day.** Flight fatigue and unpacking need buffer.
- **Group demanding excursions together** followed by rest days.
- **Book restaurant slots on Day 1**, especially at all-inclusive resorts.
- **Leave one buffer day** for weather, illness, or a spontaneous discovery.
- **Sunset time is 18:00-19:00** year-round - plan sunset-view meals accordingly.